

Chapter 4: Emotions and Moods

Learning Objectives

1. Understand the difference between emotions and moods.
 2. Identify the sources of emotions and moods.
 3. Explain the impact of emotional labor on employees.
 4. Describe affective events theory (AET).
 5. Understand emotional intelligence (EI).
 6. Explore strategies for emotion regulation.
 7. Apply concepts about emotions and moods to organizational behavior (OB) issues.
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1. Emotions and Moods

Affect, Emotions, and Moods

- **Affect:** General term for a broad range of feelings.
 - It includes **emotions** and **moods**.
- **Emotions:**
 - Short-term and intense feelings caused by specific events.
 - Examples: Happiness, sadness, anger, fear, disgust, and surprise.
 - Observable through facial expressions or body language.
- **Moods:**
 - Longer-lasting, less intense feelings that are not tied to specific events.
 - Examples: Feeling good (positive mood) or feeling down (negative mood).

Moral Emotions

- Feelings tied to our sense of right and wrong.
 - Examples: Guilt, pride, shame.
 - Learned through childhood experiences and cultural context.
 - Vary across cultures.
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2. Sources of Emotions and Moods

Personality

- Some people are naturally more emotional than others.
- **Affect Intensity:** The degree to which people feel emotions strongly.

Time of Day

- People tend to feel more positive during the middle of their awake hours.

Day of the Week

- People generally feel happier toward the end of the week (Friday through Sunday).

Weather

- Contrary to popular belief, weather has little impact on mood (illusory correlation).

Stress

- Even minor, consistent stress can worsen mood.

Social Activities

- Positive social interactions improve mood, particularly informal and physical activities.

Sleep

- Poor sleep increases negative emotions and reduces focus.

Exercise

- Regular physical activity improves mood and reduces stress, especially for people experiencing depression.

Age

- Older people experience fewer negative emotions.

Gender

- Women are generally more emotionally expressive and experience emotions more intensely than men.
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3. Emotional Labor

- Managing emotions to meet workplace expectations.
 - **Types:**
 - **Felt Emotions:** True internal emotions.
 - **Displayed Emotions:** Emotions required by the workplace.
 - **Strategies:**
 - **Surface Acting:** Hiding true emotions to comply with workplace norms.
 - **Deep Acting:** Modifying inner feelings to align with expectations.
 - Emotional labor can lead to stress and burnout if unmanaged.
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4. Affective Events Theory (AET)

- Describes how workplace events trigger emotional reactions.
- These emotional responses affect job performance and satisfaction.
- Two key messages:
 1. Emotions provide insights into how workplace events influence employees.
 2. Emotions accumulate over time and should not be ignored.

5. Emotional Intelligence (EI)

- The ability to understand and manage emotions effectively.
 - **Components:**
 - Perceiving emotions in oneself and others.
 - Understanding the meaning of emotions.
 - Regulating emotions to adapt to situations.
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6. Emotion Regulation

- Techniques to identify and modify emotions.

Emotion Regulation Strategies

1. **Surface Acting:** Pretending to feel emotions.
 2. **Deep Acting:** Changing true emotions to fit a situation.
 3. **Emotional Suppression:** Holding back emotional responses.
 4. **Cognitive Reappraisal:** Changing how you think about a situation to alter emotions.
 5. **Social Sharing:** Talking about emotions to release tension.
 6. Recruiting positive individuals and training leaders to regulate emotions effectively.
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7. Applications of Emotions and Moods in OB

Selection

- Emotional intelligence is an important factor in hiring for jobs requiring social interaction.

Decision Making

- Positive emotions improve decision quality by enhancing problem-solving and creativity.

Creativity

- Positive moods encourage flexibility and openness, boosting innovation.

Motivation

- Positive feedback and moods enhance motivation and performance.

Leadership

- Emotional appeals from leaders can inspire and influence employees.

Negotiation

- Emotions affect negotiation outcomes. Positive emotions may lead to better agreements.

Customer Service

- Employees' emotions influence customer satisfaction.
- **Emotional Contagion:** Customers "catch" the emotions displayed by employees.

Job Attitudes

- Positive work experiences lead to good moods, which carry over to home life and vice versa.

Deviant Workplace Behaviors

- Negative emotions can lead to actions that harm the organization.

Safety and Injury

- Negative emotions can increase workplace accidents. Avoid dangerous tasks when in a bad mood.

8. Implications for Managers

1. Recognize emotions as a natural part of the workplace.
2. Foster a positive emotional environment to boost performance, creativity, and decision-making.
3. Provide positive feedback and hire individuals predisposed to positivity.
4. Encourage authentic emotional expressions in customer service roles.

5. Understand and manage emotions to predict and influence employee behavior effectively.

This comprehensive summary covers all the major concepts of the provided material on emotions and moods.